

Building a Polite Bangladesh

Donor & Funder Pitch Document

Blu Foundation — Manners and Etiquette Education for Bangladesh's Children

Document Code: BLU_D16 **Version:** 1.0 **Date:** June 2026 **Status:** Draft — Confidential **Document Owner:** Blu Foundation, Bangladesh **Classification:** Restricted — For Donor and Partner Use Only

This document is intended for programme officers, CSR managers, and foundation trustees considering funding or partnership with Blu Foundation. It may be shared in confidence with relevant colleagues. Please do not reproduce or distribute publicly without written consent from Blu Foundation.

Contents

1. Executive Summary
2. The Problem We Are Solving
3. Our Solution
4. Evidence Base — Why This Works
5. Why Blu Foundation Is Different
6. Impact Projections
7. The Team
8. Budget Overview
9. Funding Ask
10. How Your Funding Is Used
11. Partnership Opportunities
12. Contact and Next Steps

Appendices

- Appendix A: Curriculum Overview
- Appendix B: Research Bibliography
- Appendix C: Organisational Chart
- Appendix D: Registration Status

1. Executive Summary

The Problem

Bangladesh has invested significantly in expanding access to primary education — enrolment now exceeds 98% — yet the system produces graduates who are academically drilled but socially underprepared. Moral and values education exists on paper in the national curriculum but is inadequately implemented in practice, with research confirming that teachers receive little guidance, no dedicated time, and no materials to deliver it meaningfully [SOURCE_BD_01]. The consequences are visible: bullying is prevalent across Bangladeshi schools at levels that cause measurable harm to children's wellbeing [SOURCE_BD_09], ethical and moral values among youth are in demonstrable decline [SOURCE_BD_15], and researchers have identified the absence of structured social norms education as a contributing factor to juvenile delinquency [SOURCE_BD_12].

Our Solution

Blu Foundation is a Bangladesh-based NGO that fills this gap through a structured, culturally grounded programme of manners and etiquette education for primary school children in Classes 1–5. Our model combines a five-textbook curriculum developed around the internationally validated CASEL social-emotional learning (SEL) framework, a two-day teacher training programme with ongoing digital support, a digital learning platform for home-based reinforcement, parent engagement workshops, and a national social media awareness campaign. Every component is explicitly designed for the Bangladeshi context: Bengali language first, Islamic cultural values integrated, and village-to-city applicability built in.

Our Ask

We are seeking a **seed-stage funding partner** to support Year 1 operations at a budget of **BDT 15–20 lakh (approximately USD 13,000–17,000)**. This investment will fund curriculum finalisation, printing of materials for two pilot schools, teacher training for ten educators, and the baseline monitoring system that will generate the evidence needed to attract growth-stage funding. By Year 3, Blu Foundation aims to reach **10,000 students across 50 schools in multiple districts**, with a total programme budget of BDT 1.5–2.0 crore.

Our Evidence Base

This is not an experiment in optimism. A landmark meta-analysis of 213 SEL programmes covering 270,034 students found that children in structured social-emotional learning programmes scored **11 percentile points higher on academic achievement tests** than those in control groups [SOURCE_GL_01]. The CASEL evidence base, drawn from over one million students across multiple countries, shows positive effects lasting up to 18 years after programme completion [SOURCE_GL_02]. The UK's Jubilee Centre character education study — covering 10,000 students across 68 schools — demonstrated measurable improvements in wellbeing, behaviour, and school community across diverse settings [SOURCE_UK_01]. Evidence-based manners and character education works. Blu Foundation brings that evidence to Bangladesh for the first time at scale.

Impact at a Glance

Phase	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Schools reached	2	10	50

Students reached	200	1,000	10,000
Teachers trained	10	50	250
Online enrolments	—	500	5,000

[FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED: Confirm these projections are consistent with founder's vision and operational capacity]

2. The Problem We Are Solving

2.1 A Curriculum Gap Hidden Behind High Enrolment Numbers

Bangladesh's record on primary school enrolment is genuinely impressive. Government investment in education infrastructure, the female stipend programme, and sustained NGO engagement have driven near-universal access. But enrolment is not education, and education is not character formation. The national primary curriculum nominally includes religious and moral education components, yet research on actual classroom delivery tells a different story: the subject is inadequately implemented, teachers are untrained in values pedagogy, and dedicated instructional time is crowded out by exam-focused academic subjects [SOURCE_BD_01]. A system can only produce what it is designed to produce. Bangladesh's primary system is designed, in practice, to produce children who can pass tests — not children who know how to treat others with dignity and respect [SOURCE_BD_02].

Structural challenges compound the problem. Bangladesh's primary schools face significant resource constraints, including large class sizes, underqualified teachers in rural areas, and limited instructional support materials beyond textbooks [SOURCE_BD_04]. In this environment, values education — which requires pedagogical skill, facilitated discussion, and consistent role-modelling — is the first thing sacrificed. Character is not tested on the Primary School Certificate. Politeness is not in the syllabus. Respect has no marks allocation. The result is a system that, despite the best intentions of its architects and teachers, leaves children's social and ethical development largely to chance [SOURCE_BD_02].

2.2 Bullying: A Documented, Overlooked Crisis

Bullying is not an occasional problem in Bangladeshi schools — it is a structural one. Research published in 2021 found that bullying is prevalent across Bangladeshi school settings, with both physical and relational forms affecting children's attendance, wellbeing, and learning outcomes [SOURCE_BD_09]. Yet school-level anti-bullying programmes are virtually non-existent. There is no national framework for prevention, no trained counsellors in primary schools, and no structured curriculum for teaching children the social-emotional skills — empathy, emotional regulation, conflict resolution — that reduce the conditions in which bullying thrives. The absence of these skills is not incidental to the problem. It is the problem.

2.3 A Generation at Risk

Research examining youth in Bangladesh has identified a worrying pattern: ethical and moral values among young people are declining, with researchers documenting shifts in attitudes toward honesty, respect for elders, social responsibility, and civic behaviour [SOURCE_BD_15]. This is not a moral panic — it is a documented trend with identifiable structural causes,

including the erosion of traditional community social learning, the rapid expansion of digital media that normalises aggressive or disrespectful interaction, and the absence of compensating formal moral education in schools.

The downstream consequences are significant. Research on juvenile delinquency in Bangladesh identifies poor socialisation, weak family-level moral education, and the absence of structured community norms as key risk factors for anti-social behaviour and criminal involvement among young people [SOURCE_BD_12]. These are not inevitable outcomes. They are the predictable result of leaving character formation to chance at the very age — the primary school years — when it is most amenable to intervention.

2.4 The Window That Is Being Missed

Child development science is unambiguous: the primary school years (ages 6–11) represent the most critical window for the formation of social habits, emotional regulation, and moral reasoning. Children in this window are actively constructing frameworks for understanding how to interact with the world. The question is not whether they will form these frameworks — they will — but whether those frameworks will be shaped by structured, culturally grounded, positive guidance, or left to form through unmediated peer interaction and media exposure.

Bangladesh has 18 million children enrolled in primary schools. Every year that passes without structured character education in those classrooms is a year in which this formation window closes without a positive intervention. Blu Foundation exists to change that — starting now, starting small, and building toward national scale.

3. Our Solution

3.1 Programme Overview

Blu Foundation operates a four-channel integrated programme model. Each channel reinforces the others, and the whole is greater than the sum of its parts. The channels are: the classroom curriculum, teacher training, a digital learning platform, and community engagement. Together, they create a consistent, multi-environment signal to children that respectful behaviour is expected, valued, and practised by the adults around them.

3.2 The Blu Foundation Curriculum: Five Textbooks, Five Years

At the core of our programme is a series of five dedicated textbooks — one per class level, Classes 1 through 5 — covering manners and etiquette in a developmentally sequenced, culturally grounded, and pedagogically rigorous way. Each textbook is an independent, standalone volume that schools can adopt without adopting the full series, but the five together constitute a complete character education journey from first grade through primary graduation.

The curriculum is structured around the CASEL (Collaborative for Academic, Social, and Emotional Learning) framework [SOURCE_GL_02], the world's leading evidence-based model for social-emotional learning in schools. The five CASEL competency domains — self-awareness, self-management, social awareness, relationship skills, and responsible decision-making — are mapped across the five class levels in an age-appropriate progression:

Class	Title	Core Focus
Class 1	<i>Hello, Good Me!</i>	Self-awareness, greetings, body language, personal cleanliness
Class 2	<i>I Eat, I Care</i>	Table manners, sharing, gratitude, social awareness at home

Class 3	<i>Respect Around Me</i>	Respect for teachers, elders, peers; classroom and public behaviour
Class 4	<i>I Speak, I Connect</i>	Communication skills, listening, disagreement without disrespect
Class 5	<i>My Community, My Responsibility</i>	Civic behaviour, community care, responsible decision-making

Each textbook contains illustrated stories, structured activities, reflection exercises, and take-home family tasks — all produced in Bengali, with cultural references drawn from Bangladeshi daily life (bazaars, mosques, rickshaw rides, family meals, school assemblies).

3.3 The SAFE Delivery Model

Blu Foundation's curriculum is not designed to be read passively. It is built around the SAFE delivery framework — Sequenced, Active, Focused, and Explicit — which Yale School of Medicine research confirms as the evidence-based gold standard for SEL programme delivery [SOURCE_GL_03]:

- **Sequenced:** Skills build on each other in a logical progression, both within each textbook and across class levels.
- **Active:** Children learn through role-play, discussion, collaborative tasks, and reflection — not passive instruction.
- **Focused:** Each lesson has a single, clearly defined behavioural or social skill as its learning objective.
- **Explicit:** Skills are named, defined, practised, and assessed explicitly — not absorbed through osmosis.

The SAFE model is the critical distinction between programmes that produce lasting behavioural change and those that produce only temporary performance. Blu Foundation is designed for the former.

3.4 Teacher Training

Teachers are the delivery mechanism for the curriculum. A good textbook in the hands of an undertrained teacher produces nothing. Blu Foundation addresses this directly through a mandatory teacher training programme that accompanies every school partnership.

The training model has two components:

Foundation Workshop (2 days): Before implementation begins, all participating teachers complete a structured two-day workshop covering the SAFE delivery model, the specific pedagogical approaches for each book, classroom management techniques for values discussions, and assessment methods for behavioural outcomes. The workshop uses participatory methods that mirror the active learning approach teachers will use with students.

Ongoing Digital Support: After the workshop, teachers receive access to a dedicated section of the Blu Foundation digital platform with lesson planning resources, video demonstrations, a peer support forum, and quarterly webinar sessions with programme staff. This maintains fidelity to the model as teachers grow in confidence.

[FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED: Islamic scholar advisory endorsements — the teacher training module includes Islamic values integration content that should carry endorsement from named scholars before final publication]

3.5 Digital Learning Platform

Bangladesh's smartphone penetration has transformed what community-level educational interventions can achieve. Blu Foundation's digital platform extends the curriculum beyond the classroom through:

- **Online courses** mirroring each textbook, accessible by students and parents via mobile phone
- **Weekly challenge prompts** sent to participating families, reinforcing the week's classroom theme at home
- **Teacher resource library** supporting ongoing professional development
- **Progress tracking dashboard** for school coordinators

The platform launches in Year 2 with a target of 500 online enrolments. By Year 3, we project 5,000 enrolments — reaching children and parents beyond the pilot school network.

3.6 Community Engagement

Character education that stops at the school gate is character education that is easily erased. Blu Foundation's community engagement strand creates reinforcing environments outside the classroom:

- **Parent Workshops:** Quarterly sessions at partner schools introducing parents to the curriculum themes, giving them language and tools to continue conversations at home
- **Religious Leader Engagement:** Coordination with local imams and mosque leadership to reinforce curriculum themes through Friday sermon content and mosque-based children's programming
- **Social Media Awareness Campaign:** A coordinated national campaign (detailed in BLU_D12) using short-form video, community challenges, and influencer partnerships to normalise respectful behaviour as a Bangladeshi cultural value and build demand for the programme

3.7 Islamic Cultural Integration

Bangladesh is a majority-Muslim country, and Blu Foundation's curriculum is not culturally neutral — it is culturally explicit. The five textbooks deliberately draw on Islamic teachings on respect (ihtiram), gratitude (shukr), honesty (sidq), and community responsibility (amanah) alongside universal values shared across faiths and secular ethical frameworks. This integration serves two purposes: it makes the content feel authentic and relevant to children and families, and it creates natural alignment with religious education that already occurs in homes and mosques.

[FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED: Islamic scholar advisory endorsements — list names and affiliations of advisors who have reviewed and endorsed the curriculum's Islamic values integration. This section will be updated once formal endorsements are secured.]

4. Evidence Base — Why This Works

A Note to Sceptical Readers

Programme officers at international organisations and CSR managers at major corporations receive many pitches. Most cite evidence loosely — gesturing at research without engaging with it. This section is written for the reader who wants to know specifically: what is the evidence, how strong is it, how relevant is it to Bangladesh, and what should we realistically expect this programme to achieve? We invite scrutiny. The evidence holds up.

4.1 The Landmark Meta-Analysis: 213 SEL Programmes, 270,034 Students

The most rigorous and widely cited study of school-based social-emotional learning was conducted by Durlak and colleagues in 2011 [SOURCE_GL_01]. The researchers conducted a meta-analysis — a systematic synthesis of evidence across multiple studies — covering 213 school-based SEL programmes and 270,034 students. Their findings were unambiguous:

- Students in SEL programmes demonstrated **11 percentile point gains in academic achievement** compared to control groups
- They showed **significant improvements in social skills** and **reductions in conduct problems and emotional distress**
- The effects held across school settings, age groups, and programme approaches
- The strongest predictors of positive outcomes were programmes that followed the SAFE delivery model — the exact model Blu Foundation uses

This is not a marginal or contested finding. It has been replicated and extended by subsequent research. It is the empirical foundation on which Blu Foundation's programme model is built.

4.2 CASEL: A Million Students, Effects Lasting 18 Years

The Collaborative for Academic, Social, and Emotional Learning (CASEL) has built the world's largest evidence base for SEL programmes in schools [SOURCE_GL_02]. Across a research body encompassing over one million students studied in rigorous trials and longitudinal follow-ups:

- SEL programmes produce consistent, replicable improvements in social behaviour, school climate, and academic outcomes
- Effects are not temporary: studies tracking students 6, 12, and 18 years after programme completion show lasting differences in wellbeing, prosocial behaviour, and life outcomes
- The CASEL competency framework — on which Blu Foundation's curriculum is directly modelled — is the most widely validated structure for organising SEL content across grade levels

The Blu Foundation curriculum is not derived from intuition or tradition alone. It is mapped to a framework that has been tested at scale across diverse cultural and economic settings.

4.3 Yale Research: SEL Improves Academic Performance and Wellbeing

Yale School of Medicine research confirms that SEL programmes following the SAFE delivery model — Sequenced, Active, Focused, Explicit — produce the strongest outcomes across both academic and wellbeing measures [SOURCE_GL_03]. The research, published in *Child Development*, found that SAFE-adherent programmes produced consistent improvements in students' academic performance, sense of safety at school, and positive social behaviours. Programmes that deviated from the SAFE structure showed weaker and less consistent effects. Blu Foundation's curriculum and teacher training are designed around SAFE compliance from the ground up.

4.4 UK Character Education: 10,000 Students, 68 Schools

The Jubilee Centre for Character and Virtues at the University of Birmingham conducted a large-scale study of character education in UK schools covering 10,000 students, 255 teachers, and 68 schools [SOURCE_UK_01]. The study found:

- Schools with explicit, structured character education programmes showed measurable improvements in student wellbeing, behaviour, and school community cohesion

- The effects were strongest in schools where character education was treated as a whole-school priority — not a standalone subject
- Teacher confidence and clarity about character education goals were the strongest school-level predictors of positive student outcomes

The UK context is not identical to Bangladesh, but the structural lessons are directly applicable: programme success depends on explicit design, teacher preparation, and institutional commitment — all of which Blu Foundation's model addresses.

4.5 The Key Success Factor: Dedicated Staffing and Explicit Programmes

The UK Government's 2017 report *Developing Character Skills in Schools* identified the most consistent predictor of successful character education outcomes across 255 teachers in its national sample: **dedicated staffing and explicit programme structures** [SOURCE_UK_02]. Schools that embedded character education into existing subject teaching with no dedicated resources, materials, or training produced inconsistent and largely unmeasurable outcomes. Schools with dedicated programmes, trained staff, and explicit content produced reliable, measurable improvements.

This finding directly informs Blu Foundation's design choices. We do not ask teachers to absorb values education into an already crowded curriculum. We provide dedicated materials, dedicated training, and dedicated digital support — the precise combination the evidence identifies as effective.

4.6 Core Components of Effective SEL: What the Research Requires

Research on evidence-based SEL programmes identifies a consistent set of core components that distinguish effective interventions from ineffective ones [SOURCE_ALT_01]:

1. **Clear learning objectives** tied to specific social-emotional competencies
2. **Sequential skill-building** across lesson and programme structure
3. **Active learning methods** rather than passive instruction
4. **Teacher training** with ongoing support and fidelity monitoring
5. **Family and community engagement** reinforcing programme themes at home
6. **Assessment mechanisms** tracking behavioural outcomes, not just attendance

Blu Foundation's programme model is designed to meet all six criteria. This is not coincidence — the programme model was built by working backwards from the evidence.

5. Why Blu Foundation Is Different

Bangladesh already has organisations working in education, in child welfare, and in values promotion. A funder is entitled to ask: what does Blu Foundation add that does not already exist? The answer lies in five specific differentiators.

5.1 Culturally Rooted, Not Culturally Imposed

Most SEL and character education programmes available in developing contexts are translations or adaptations of Western curricula — designed in the United States or Europe and retrofitted for local use. The cultural mismatch creates

friction: the scenarios feel foreign, the values hierarchy may not align with local religious and community norms, and teachers lack ownership because the content does not feel like theirs.

Blu Foundation is built from Bangladesh outward. Every scenario, character name, illustration setting, and cultural reference is drawn from Bangladeshi daily life. Islamic values are not an add-on — they are woven into the content from the first draft. Bengali is not a translation — it is the original language of composition. When a child in Sylhet or Mymensingh opens a Blu Foundation textbook, they see their world in it.

5.2 Age-Sequenced and Developmentally Appropriate

Many values education efforts in South Asia operate as a single assembly speech, a poster campaign, or a one-time workshop. Blu Foundation's model is developmentally sequenced across five class levels, with content calibrated to what children at each stage can understand, practise, and internalise. A Class 1 child learns to greet with eye contact and a warm expression. A Class 5 child practises respectful disagreement and civic responsibility. The skills scaffold — each year builds on the last.

This matters because character formation is not an event. It is a process. A five-year, sequenced engagement with social-emotional skills produces fundamentally different outcomes from a one-time intervention at any single class level.

5.3 Whole-Community, Not School-Only

Blu Foundation explicitly rejects the model in which character education is the school's problem alone. Children spend more waking hours outside school than inside it. Parents, siblings, neighbours, and religious community leaders have a greater cumulative influence on a child's social development than any classroom does. Our community engagement strand — parent workshops, religious leader coordination, digital platform for home use, and social media campaign — creates a consistent message across every environment the child inhabits.

This whole-community approach is not an optional add-on. It is a core programme commitment backed by evidence that programmes with family engagement components produce significantly stronger and more durable outcomes than school-only interventions.

5.4 Measurable Outcomes, Not Attendance Counting

Too many NGO programmes in education measure success by outputs — books distributed, students enrolled, teachers who attended a workshop — rather than outcomes: did behaviour actually change? Blu Foundation commits to outcome measurement from Year 1. Every partner school completes a pre-programme baseline assessment of student social behaviour using validated instruments adapted for the Bangladeshi context, and a post-programme assessment at the end of each academic year. These assessments track specific, observable behavioural indicators — not self-reported attitudes or teacher impressions alone.

The Monitoring and Evaluation Framework (BLU_D17) details the full assessment methodology. Donors receive quarterly reports with outcome data, not just activity summaries.

5.5 Scalable by Design

The textbook model is the most scalable educational delivery mechanism ever invented. Once a textbook is written, edited, designed, and approved, it can be printed in any quantity at a predictable per-unit cost. The Blu Foundation digital platform further reduces the marginal cost of reaching additional students: once built, it serves 500 users or 50,000 users with minimal incremental cost. The teacher training model is designed to cascade — senior trained teachers can themselves become trainers, creating a self-replicating capacity-building system.

6. Impact Projections

The following projections represent Blu Foundation's target impact trajectory across the first three years of operation. They are ambitious but grounded in realistic assessments of organisational capacity, budget availability, and the pace of school-level adoption.

[FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED: Confirm these projections are consistent with the founder's vision and operational planning. These will be used in formal grant applications.]

6.1 Quantitative Impact Table

Metric	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Schools reached	2	10	50
Students reached	200	1,000	10,000
Teachers trained	10	50	250
Districts covered	1 (pilot)	3	National coverage begins
Online course enrolments	—	500	5,000
Parent workshops delivered	4	20	100
Textbook units distributed	1,000	5,000	50,000

6.2 Qualitative Milestones

By end of Year 1:

- Complete, peer-reviewed five-textbook series published and distributed to pilot schools
- Baseline and endline behavioural assessments completed for Year 1 cohort
- Teacher training model tested and refined based on practitioner feedback
- First independent assessment report produced for donor reporting

By end of Year 2:

- Digital platform live with active user base
- Expansion to multiple districts, with evidence of programme fidelity in non-pilot schools
- First published outcomes data demonstrating measurable behavioural change
- NGOAB registration and compliance fully established

By end of Year 3:

- Programme at sufficient scale to approach government for MoPME partnership discussions
- National social media campaign reaching millions of impressions
- Self-sustaining teacher training cascade beginning, reducing per-school onboarding cost
- Evidence base sufficient for international peer-reviewed publication

6.3 Long-Term Vision

By Year 5, Blu Foundation aims to have the programme embedded in primary school systems across Bangladesh's 64 districts, with a trajectory toward integration into the national primary curriculum. The textbook series, once adopted by the National Curriculum and Textbook Board (NCTB), would reach the entire primary enrolment of approximately 18 million children — the largest single impact opportunity in Bangladeshi character education.

This is the horizon we are working toward. Year 1 is the proof of concept that makes Year 5 credible.

7. The Team

7.1 Founder

[FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED: Founder bio — 2–3 sentences on background, professional qualification, relevant experience, and personal motivation for this work. Draft placeholder below:]

Blu Foundation is led by [Founder Name], a [qualification / professional background] with [X] years of experience in [field — education / development / NGO sector / social enterprise]. [Personal story: why this issue matters to the founder — a specific experience, observation, or conviction that led to founding Blu Foundation. This narrative is the most powerful element of any pitch; be specific and personal.]

[Founder Name] holds [educational credentials] and has previously [relevant professional achievement]. [Any prior NGO, teaching, or community work that demonstrates credibility for this specific mission.]

7.2 Core Team

[FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED: Full team bios. For each team member, provide: name, title, 2–3 sentence biography, relevant qualifications, and their specific role in programme delivery. If full-time staff have not yet been hired, indicate which roles are currently filled by the founder or volunteers, and when paid staff will be onboarded.]

Blu Foundation's core programme team includes the following roles:

- **Executive Director / Founder:** Programme strategy, donor relationships, government engagement
- **Curriculum Lead:** Textbook development, pedagogical review, teacher training design
- **Digital Programme Manager:** Online platform development and management, social media campaign
- **Monitoring and Evaluation Officer:** Assessment tool development, data collection, donor reporting

- **Finance and Operations Manager:** Budget management, NGOAB compliance, audit coordination

[Names and biographies to be inserted once team is confirmed.]

7.3 Advisory Board

[FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED: Advisory board names, affiliations, and brief statement of their advisory role. Recommended advisory board composition: 1–2 education academics, 1 NGO sector senior leader, 1 Islamic scholar, 1 private sector / CSR leader, 1 government education official (serving or retired). Named advisors significantly strengthen funder credibility assessments.]

Blu Foundation's Advisory Board includes representatives from the education research community, NGO sector, Islamic scholarship, and private sector leadership. [Full names and affiliations to be inserted.]

7.4 Research Partners

[FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED: Any existing relationships with BRAC University, BRAC Institute of Educational Development (BIED), Institute of Education and Research (IER) at Dhaka University, or other academic institutions. Research partnerships significantly strengthen international funder applications.]

Blu Foundation is in discussion with [institution name(s)] regarding research partnership for independent programme evaluation. [Details to be confirmed.]

7.5 Organisational Culture

Blu Foundation is committed to practising what it teaches. The organisation's internal culture reflects the same values of respect, dignity, and honest communication that the curriculum asks children to learn. Staff appraisals include behavioural criteria alongside performance metrics. All staff and volunteers are required to complete the same SAFE-model orientation that teachers receive. We believe that an organisation building a culture of respect must demonstrate it in its own operations.

8. Budget Overview

8.1 Overview

The three-year budget below represents indicative projections for planning and funder communication purposes. Detailed line-item budgets are available in BLU_D18 (3-Year Budget Template). All figures are in Bangladesh Taka (BDT) unless otherwise stated.

[FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED: Confirm budget figures are consistent with founder's planning assumptions. These are working estimates and should be validated before submission to any specific funder.]

8.2 Three-Year Budget Summary

Budget Category	Year 1 (BDT)	Year 2 (BDT)	Year 3 (BDT)
Curriculum development (writing, editing, design, peer review)	4,00,000–5,00,000	50,000–1,00,000	50,000
Printing and distribution (textbooks, teacher guides)	2,00,000–3,00,000	8,00,000–10,00,000	35,00,000–40,00,000
Teacher training (workshops, materials, facilitators)	1,50,000–2,00,000	6,00,000–8,00,000	25,00,000–30,00,000
Digital platform (development, hosting, content upload)	50,000–1,00,000	15,00,000–20,00,000	8,00,000–10,00,000
Social media campaign (content production, advertising)	1,00,000–1,50,000	5,00,000–7,00,000	15,00,000–18,00,000
Staff costs (salaries, benefits)	3,00,000–4,00,000	12,00,000–15,00,000	40,00,000–50,00,000
Monitoring and evaluation (tools, data collection, reporting)	50,000–1,00,000	3,00,000–5,00,000	8,00,000–12,00,000
Contingency (15%)	~2,00,000	~8,00,000–10,00,000	~20,00,000–25,00,000
TOTAL (approximate range)	BDT 15–20 lakh	BDT 60–80 lakh	BDT 1.5–2.0 crore

Notes: BDT amounts presented in South Asian number format (lakh = 100,000; crore = 10,000,000). USD conversions provided in Section 9. Year 1 is curriculum-heavy; Year 2 is digital-platform-heavy; Year 3 reflects scale economies on curriculum with significant increase in printing and staffing for 50-school coverage.

8.3 Budget Principles

- **Programme-first:** A minimum of 80% of funds in every year are allocated to direct programme delivery
- **Transparent reporting:** All expenditure tracked in a donor-accessible reporting system; quarterly financial statements provided
- **Annual audit:** Certified external audit by a Bangladesh-registered chartered accountant firm
- **Conservative contingency:** 15% contingency held in every year to manage cost overruns and exchange rate movements

9. Funding Ask

9.1 We Are Looking for Partners at Three Stages

Blu Foundation recognises that different funders have different risk appetites, portfolio priorities, and grant cycles. We have structured our funding ask to be legible to three distinct funder types:

SEED / STARTUP FUNDER — YEAR 1

What this funds: Curriculum finalisation, initial printing for two pilot schools, teacher training for ten educators, baseline M&E system setup, NGOAB registration completion, and six months of core staff costs.

The ask: BDT 15–20 lakh (approximately USD 13,000–17,000)*

What you get: A named founding funder role; first access to Year 1 outcomes data; opportunity to observe pilot school implementation; co-branding on curriculum materials (if desired); Blu Foundation's first published evidence report as a joint publication.

Who this suits: Individual philanthropists, small family foundations, domestic corporate CSR programmes, or international foundations with emerging organisation grants.

GROWTH FUNDER — YEAR 2

What this funds: Expansion from 2 to 10 schools, digital platform development and launch, scaling teacher training to 50 educators, expansion to three districts, and the first independent impact evaluation.

The ask: BDT 60–80 lakh (approximately USD 52,000–70,000)*

What you get: Programme co-design input for scale phase; named partnership on digital platform; co-authorship opportunity on first published outcomes study; quarterly briefings with programme leadership; school visit programme for trustees or senior staff.

Who this suits: UNICEF Bangladesh Innovation Fund, USAID education grants, EU development programmes, UK Aid / FCDO education portfolio, BRAC Foundation, Aga Khan Foundation Bangladesh, or major domestic corporate CSR programmes.

SCALE FUNDER — YEAR 3 AND BEYOND

What this funds: Expansion to 50 schools across multiple districts, full-time staffing for regional coordinators, national social media campaign, digital platform scaling to 5,000 users, and government partnership engagement toward NCTB integration.

The ask: BDT 1.5–2.0 crore (approximately USD 130,000–175,000)*

What you get: Founding institutional partnership status; involvement in government integration strategy; joint application for international replication in comparable South Asian markets; published case study featuring partnership; full access to programme data for independent analysis.

Who this suits: USAID Bangladesh education programme, EU Horizon or development fund, UK Aid / FCDO, UNICEF global education innovation, or a consortium of two to three complementary funders.

USD conversions are approximate based on prevailing exchange rates. Please verify current BDT/USD rate at time of grant application.

9.2 Priority Funding Targets

The following organisations represent Blu Foundation's primary prospective funding targets, ranked by strategic fit:

International Organisations

- UNICEF Bangladesh — Education and child development portfolio; Innovation Fund
- USAID Bangladesh — Education quality and equity programmes
- European Union Delegation to Bangladesh — Civil society and education development grants
- UK Aid / FCDO Bangladesh — Education and skills programming
- Aga Khan Foundation Bangladesh — Community development and education

International Foundations

- BRAC Foundation — Direct alignment with Bangladesh education mission
- Porticus Foundation — Global Catholic social education mandate
- Hewlett Foundation — Education and values programmes

Domestic — Corporate CSR

- Grameenphone (Telenor Group) — CSR focus on digital education and youth
- Robi Axiata — Community development and education CSR
- Banglalink — Youth and community CSR programmes
- Dutch-Bangla Bank Foundation — Education support grants
- BRAC Bank — Social enterprise and education funding
- Square Group CSR — Health and education focus

Domestic — Foundations

- Aarong / Aarong Cause — Social development programming
- BRAC University BIED — Research partnership with co-funding potential

[FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED: Identify any existing donor relationships, warm introductions, or prior contact with any of the above organisations. Personal introductions significantly accelerate grant processes. Also note any domestic contacts through professional network who could provide CSR referrals.]

10. How Your Funding Is Used

Blu Foundation is committed to the highest standards of financial transparency. We know that donors have been burned before by NGOs where programme expenditure was opaque, overhead was hidden, and impact was unmeasurable. We are building our organisation from the outset on a different standard.

10.1 Expenditure Ratios

Category	Year 1 Target	Year 2 Target	Year 3 Target
Programme delivery (curriculum, printing, training, digital)	≥80%	≥80%	≥82%
Administration (management, compliance, HR)	≤15%	≤15%	≤13%
Monitoring and evaluation	5%	5%	5%

These ratios are targets, not aspirations. They will be reported against actuals in every quarterly donor report and verified by the annual external audit.

10.2 Governance and Accountability

- **Annual external audit** by a Bangladesh-registered, ICAB-member chartered accountancy firm, with results shared with all donors
- **NGOAB registration** ensures Blu Foundation operates under the regulatory oversight of the NGO Affairs Bureau, Government of Bangladesh — including mandatory annual reporting
- **FD-6 and FD-7 compliance** for all foreign donor funds, in accordance with Bangladesh NGO registration requirements
- **Quarterly donor reports** provided to all funders of BDT 5 lakh or more, including programme activity summary, expenditure statement, outcome data, and next quarter targets
- **Named contact person** for each donor — not a generic email address, but a named programme staff member who is responsible for the relationship

10.3 What We Will Not Do

We will not spend donor money on:

- International travel not directly required for programme delivery or funder reporting
- Consultant fees for work that can be done by staff
- Promotional events with no programme function
- Overhead costs that are not transparently disclosed in donor reports

11. Partnership Opportunities

Funding is the most common form of partnership, but it is not the only one. Blu Foundation actively welcomes non-monetary partnerships that contribute skills, networks, or resources that money cannot easily buy.

11.1 In-Kind Partnerships

Resource	How It Helps	Ideal Partner Type
Printing services	Textbook and teacher guide production	Commercial printers, paper suppliers

Design services	Illustration, layout, digital content	Creative agencies with CSR programmes
Paper supply	Raw material for print run	Paper mills, import companies
Office space	Pilot-phase operational base	Business parks, universities
Photography / video	Campaign and documentation content	Media companies, production houses

11.2 Technical Partnerships

Resource	How It Helps	Ideal Partner Type
LMS platform hosting	Digital course delivery	EdTech companies, cloud providers
App development	Mobile version of digital platform	Tech companies with CSR / pro bono capacity
Data management systems	M&E data collection and analysis	Software companies
Bangla-language content support	Language review and quality assurance	Academic institutions, publishing houses

11.3 Network and Access Partnerships

Resource	How It Helps	Ideal Partner Type
School introductions	Access to pilot partner schools	Teacher unions, school networks
Government relationships	Engagement with MoPME, DPE, NCTB	Civil society organisations with government track record
Parent community networks	Community engagement and parent workshops	Mosque committees, community centres
Media partnerships	Social media campaign amplification	Broadcasters, newspapers, digital media platforms

11.4 Research and Knowledge Partnerships

Resource	How It Helps	Ideal Partner Type
Independent evaluation	Credibility of impact claims	Universities, independent research organisations
Co-publication	International visibility for Bangladesh evidence	Academic journals, policy institutes
Curriculum peer review	Validation of content by subject experts	Education departments, curriculum specialists

If your organisation can contribute in any of these ways, we would welcome a conversation. The most effective partnerships we anticipate will combine financial contribution with one or more non-monetary elements — and we are flexible in structuring arrangements that create genuine value for both partners.

12. Contact and Next Steps

12.1 Contact

[FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED: Insert the following details before sending this document to any funder or partner:]

Organisation	Blu Foundation
Contact Name	[Name]
Title	[Title — e.g., Founder and Executive Director]
Email	[email@blufoundation.org.bd]
Phone	[+880 — — — — —]
Website	[www.blufoundation.org.bd]
Address	[Registered office address, Bangladesh]
NGOAB Registration Number	[To be inserted on registration]

12.2 What We Offer Interested Funders

Before any commitment is required, we offer:

- **School visit:** Observe a pilot classroom session and meet the teachers and students involved
- **Team briefing:** A 45-minute video call with programme leadership walking through the curriculum, evidence base, and M&E approach
- **Stakeholder introduction:** Connection with our advisory board members, partner school principals, or community leaders who can speak to local context
- **Site visit for due diligence:** Full transparency on operations, finances, and team for any funder conducting formal due diligence

12.3 Timeline

[FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED: Insert realistic dates based on your planning. Suggested template:]

Blu Foundation is currently seeking funding commitments by [Month/Year] in order to begin Year 1 operations in [Quarter/Year]. The programme is designed to launch in [Month] to align with the Bangladesh academic year, which begins in [January]. Early commitments allow us to begin curriculum printing and teacher training scheduling in advance of the school year.

Key planning milestones:

Milestone	Target Date
Funding commitment received	[Date]
NGOAB registration completed	[Date]
Curriculum final print-ready files	[Date]
Teacher training workshop	[Date]
Pilot school launch — Semester 1	[Date]
Baseline assessment completed	[Date]
First donor report	[Date]

12.4 How to Proceed

If this document raises questions, we welcome them — we would rather answer a difficult question in a conversation than have it stop a potential partnership before it starts. If you are ready to discuss terms, please reach out directly to [Founder Name] at [email]. We will respond within two working days.

We are building something that Bangladesh needs and that evidence says will work. We are looking for partners who see that too. We hope you are one of them.

Appendix A: Curriculum Overview

Five Textbooks — Five Years of Character Formation

The Blu Foundation curriculum spans the complete primary school journey from Class 1 through Class 5. Each textbook is a standalone volume usable independently, but the series as a whole constitutes a sequenced, five-year character education programme aligned with the CASEL social-emotional learning framework [SOURCE_GL_02].

Class 1 — *Hello, Good Me!* CASEL Domain: Self-Awareness and Self-Management

The first-year textbook introduces the youngest learners to the foundational habits of respectful self-presentation: greeting with warmth and eye contact, personal cleanliness as a mark of self-respect and respect for others, appropriate body language in different social settings (home, school, mosque, market), and the basics of sharing and turn-taking. Content is delivered through illustrated stories featuring a recurring cast of child characters living in a Bangladeshi village and city setting. Activities include role-play, mirror exercises, and simple take-home challenges for families.

Class 2 — *I Eat, I Care* CASEL Domain: Social Awareness

The second-year textbook focuses on the social dimensions of eating and home life — areas where children's manners are most immediately visible to family and community. Topics include table manners in Bangladeshi cultural context (eating with the right hand, waiting for elders, not wasting food), expressing gratitude for meals and hospitality, behaviour in the

home of others, and early concepts of caring for shared spaces. Islamic teachings on gratitude (shukr) and cleanliness (taharah) are explicitly integrated.

Class 3 — *Respect Around Me* CASEL Domain: *Social Awareness and Relationship Skills*

The third-year textbook broadens the child's relational world outward from home to school, community, and public spaces. Topics include respectful address of teachers and elders (correct forms of salutation in Bengali), classroom behaviour (listening, waiting to speak, not interrupting), public behaviour (behaviour on transport, in shops, at religious sites), and early concepts of kindness toward those who are different or less fortunate. This textbook also introduces the concept of bullying and its impact on others — the first explicit anti-bullying content in the series [SOURCE_BD_09].

Class 4 — *I Speak, I Connect* CASEL Domain: *Relationship Skills and Responsible Decision-Making*

The fourth-year textbook addresses communication as a social skill: how we speak matters as much as what we say. Topics include active listening, giving and receiving constructive feedback, expressing disagreement without disrespect, digital communication etiquette (including responsible use of messaging and social media, relevant to Bangladeshi adolescent context) [SOURCE_BD_13], and the difference between assertiveness and aggression. This textbook has the highest direct relevance to bullying prevention, introducing bystander skills and tools for de-escalation.

Class 5 — *My Community, My Responsibility* CASEL Domain: *Responsible Decision-Making and Community Contribution*

The fifth and final textbook in the series takes the longest view — the child as a community member and future citizen. Topics include civic responsibility (keeping public spaces clean, respecting community property), volunteering and service, understanding the perspectives of those with different backgrounds, responsible environmental behaviour, and an introduction to the concept of social leadership. The textbook closes the five-year journey by asking students to articulate their own character commitments — a personal pledge framed within both universal ethical principles and Islamic values of khalifa (stewardship) and amanah (responsibility).

Appendix B: Research Bibliography

The following source keys are used throughout this document. Full bibliographic details for each source are maintained in the Blu Foundation Source Registry ([sources/SOURCE_REGISTRY.md](#)).

Bangladesh-Specific Sources

Key	Description
[SOURCE_BD_01]	ResearchGate (2024) — Cultivating Values Through Education: Insights from Primary School Teachers in Bangladesh
[SOURCE_BD_02]	RSIS International — Education System in Bangladesh: A Conflicting Approach to Building a Good Citizen

[SOURCE_BD_04]	ResearchGate (2024) — Beyond the Classroom: Structural and Qualitative Challenges in Bangladesh's Primary Education
[SOURCE_BD_09]	PMC / NCBI (2021) — Prevalence and Nature of Bullying in Schools of Bangladesh: A Pilot Study
[SOURCE_BD_12]	ResearchGate — Socio-Economic, Cultural and Family Factors Causing Juvenile Delinquency in Bangladesh
[SOURCE_BD_13]	ResearchGate (2023) — Social Media Activities of Bangladeshi Secondary School Students and Its Influence on Students Behaviour
[SOURCE_BD_15]	AIJSH (2020) — Declining Ethical and Moral Values Among Youth

Global SEL Sources

Key	Description
[SOURCE_GL_01]	Durlak et al. (2011) — The Impact of Enhancing Students' Social and Emotional Learning: A Meta-Analysis of School-Based Universal Interventions (213 programs, 270,034 students) — PubMed
[SOURCE_GL_02]	CASEL — What Does the Research Say: SEL Evidence Base (1 million+ students; effects lasting up to 18 years)
[SOURCE_GL_03]	Yale School of Medicine — New Research: SEL Significantly Improves Academic Performance and Well-Being

UK Character Education Sources

Key	Description
[SOURCE_UK_01]	Jubilee Centre for Character and Virtues (2015) — Character Education in UK Schools (10,000 students, 255 teachers, 68 schools)
[SOURCE_UK_02]	UK Government (2017) — Developing Character Skills in Schools: Summary Report

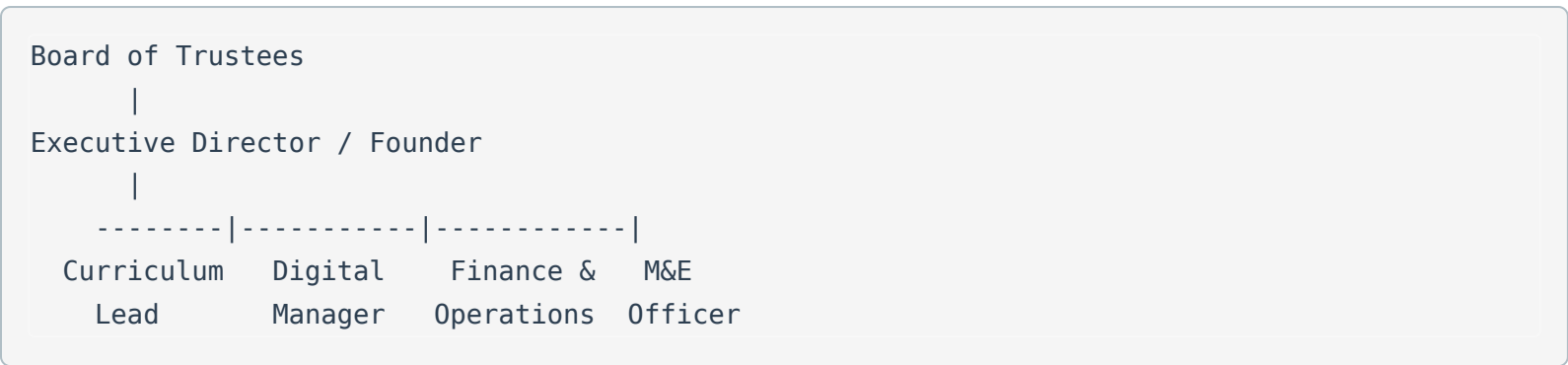
Alternative and Supplementary Sources

Key	Description
[SOURCE_ALT_01]	PMC — Core Components of Evidence-Based SEL Programs

Appendix C: Organisational Chart

[FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED: An organisational chart showing the governance and management structure of Blu Foundation should be inserted here. For Year 1, this may be a simple structure showing the Board of Trustees, Executive Director, and any programme staff or volunteers. It should include named individuals where these have been confirmed.]

Placeholder structure (to be replaced with named chart):



Full organisational chart with named individuals to be provided separately.

Appendix D: Registration Status

[FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED: Insert current status of NGO registration. This is critical for international funders, who will require registration evidence before disbursing funds. Include:]

- *Current registration status (applied / pending / granted)*
- *NGO Affairs Bureau (NGOAB) registration number (once issued)*
- *Date of application and expected completion*
- *Whether the organisation is registered as a company limited by guarantee (Section 28) or under the Societies Registration Act, and why*
- *Bank account details (name of bank, account type) — required for FD-6 / FD-7 foreign fund compliance*
- *Confirmation of compliance with the Foreign Donations (Voluntary Activities) Regulation Act 2016*

Blu Foundation is currently in the process of completing registration under [applicable registration framework]. Registration number and confirmation documentation will be provided to all prospective funders upon request and will be updated in this document upon completion.

End of Document

BLU_D16 — Donor & Funder Pitch Document Version 1.0 | June 2026 | Draft — Confidential Blu Foundation, Bangladesh

For permissions or queries regarding this document, contact [FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED: contact email].